

ABOUT THIS BOOK

This book introduces matrices through high school coordinate geometry. This approach makes it easier for beginners to learn Python for scientific computing. All problems in the book are from NCERT mathematics textbooks from Class 9-12. Exercises are from CBSE board exam papers.

The content is sufficient for industry jobs and covers nearly all matrix prerequisites for machine learning. There is no copyright, so readers are free to print and share.

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In this edition, some incorrect solutions were removed. All figures redrawn. More problems added.

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1. GATE CE-1 2026

A. Formulae

1.1.1 Intersection of Conics and Common Chord

- Conic in Vector Form: Every second-degree curve $ax^2 + 2bxy + cy^2 + 2dx + 2ey + f = 0$ can be written in matrix-vector form as:

$$\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{V} \mathbf{x} + 2\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{x} + f = 0, \quad \mathbf{V} = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ b & c \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{V}^\top, \quad \mathbf{u} = \begin{pmatrix} d \\ e \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.1.1.1)$$

The conic is classified by the determinant of $\mathbf{V}$:

$$|\mathbf{V}| = \begin{vmatrix} a & b \\ b & c \end{vmatrix} = ac - b^2 \begin{cases} = 0, & \text{parabola} \\ > 0, & \text{ellipse} \\ < 0, & \text{hyperbola} \end{cases} \quad (1.1.1.2)$$

For a circle with centre $\mathbf{c}$ and radius r , $\|\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{c}\|^2 = r^2$ gives $\mathbf{V} = \mathbf{I}$, $\mathbf{u} = -\mathbf{c}$, and $f = \|\mathbf{c}\|^2 - r^2$.

- Line-Conic Intersection: The points of intersection of a line $L : \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{h} + \kappa \mathbf{m}$ ($\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$) with a conic section $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{V} \mathbf{x} + 2\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{x} + f = 0$ are given by:

$$\mathbf{x}_i = \mathbf{h} + \kappa_i \mathbf{m} \quad (1.1.1.3)$$

where the parameter values κ_i are:

$$\kappa_i = \frac{-\mathbf{m}^\top (\mathbf{V} \mathbf{h} + \mathbf{u}) \pm \sqrt{[\mathbf{m}^\top (\mathbf{V} \mathbf{h} + \mathbf{u})]^2 - g(\mathbf{h}) (\mathbf{m}^\top \mathbf{V} \mathbf{m})}}{\mathbf{m}^\top \mathbf{V} \mathbf{m}} \quad (1.1.1.4)$$

with

$$g(\mathbf{h}) = \mathbf{h}^\top \mathbf{V} \mathbf{h} + 2\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{h} + f \quad (1.1.1.5)$$

The line meets the conic at two, one, or no real points according as the discriminant

$$\Delta = [\mathbf{m}^\top (\mathbf{V} \mathbf{h} + \mathbf{u})]^2 - g(\mathbf{h}) (\mathbf{m}^\top \mathbf{V} \mathbf{m}) \quad (1.1.1.6)$$

is positive, zero, or negative.

- Derivation of the Intersection Parameter: Substituting $\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{h} + \kappa \mathbf{m}$ into the conic equation and using symmetry $\mathbf{V} = \mathbf{V}^\top$:

$$(\mathbf{h} + \kappa \mathbf{m})^\top \mathbf{V} (\mathbf{h} + \kappa \mathbf{m}) + 2\mathbf{u}^\top (\mathbf{h} + \kappa \mathbf{m}) + f = 0 \quad (1.1.1.7)$$

$$\kappa^2 (\mathbf{m}^\top \mathbf{V} \mathbf{m}) + 2\kappa \mathbf{m}^\top (\mathbf{V} \mathbf{h} + \mathbf{u}) + g(\mathbf{h}) = 0 \quad (1.1.1.8)$$

When $\Delta = 0$, the two roots coincide and the line is tangent to the conic.

- Pencil of Conics: The intersection of two conics with parameters $(\mathbf{V}_1, \mathbf{u}_1, f_1)$ and $(\mathbf{V}_2, \mathbf{u}_2, f_2)$ lies on every member of the pencil:

$$\mathbf{x}^\top (\mathbf{V}_1 + \mu \mathbf{V}_2) \mathbf{x} + 2(\mathbf{u}_1 + \mu \mathbf{u}_2)^\top \mathbf{x} + (f_1 + \mu f_2) = 0 \quad (1.1.1.9)$$

- Degenerate Conic and Common Chord: The pencil represents a pair of straight

lines (a degenerate conic) if and only if:

$$\begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{V}_1 + \mu \mathbf{V}_2 & \mathbf{u}_1 + \mu \mathbf{u}_2 \\ (\mathbf{u}_1 + \mu \mathbf{u}_2)^\top & f_1 + \mu f_2 \end{vmatrix} = 0 \quad (1.1.1.10)$$

If $\mathbf{V}_1 = \mathbf{V}_2$ (e.g., two circles), choosing $\mu = -1$ removes the second-degree terms, leaving the common chord (radical axis):

$$2(\mathbf{u}_1 - \mathbf{u}_2)^\top \mathbf{x} + (f_1 - f_2) = 0 \quad (1.1.1.11)$$

1.1.2 Line Intersection and Angle Between Vectors

- **Forms of a Line:** A line through point $\mathbf{A}$ with direction vector $\mathbf{m}$ can be written in parametric form or normal form using normal vector $\mathbf{n}$ ($\mathbf{n}^\top \mathbf{m} = 0$):

$$\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{A} + \kappa \mathbf{m}, \quad \mathbf{n}^\top (\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{A}) = 0 \quad (1.1.2.1)$$

In 2D, if $\mathbf{m} = \begin{pmatrix} m_1 \\ m_2 \end{pmatrix}$, then

$$\mathbf{n} = \begin{pmatrix} -m_2 \\ m_1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.1.2.2)$$

- **Line Intersection and Solvability:** The lines $\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{A} + \kappa_1 \mathbf{m}_1$ and $\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{B} + \kappa_2 \mathbf{m}_2$ meet where:

$$(\mathbf{m}_1 \quad -\mathbf{m}_2) \begin{pmatrix} \kappa_1 \\ \kappa_2 \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{B} - \mathbf{A} \quad (1.1.2.3)$$

This system has a unique solution if and only if $|\mathbf{m}_1 \quad \mathbf{m}_2| \neq 0$. If the determinant is zero, the lines are parallel or coincident.

- **Angle Between Vectors:** The angle θ between two vectors $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$ is given by:

$$\cos \theta = \frac{\mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{b}}{\|\mathbf{a}\| \|\mathbf{b}\|} \quad (1.1.2.4)$$

Two vectors are orthogonal if and only if $\mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{b} = 0$.

- **Circle Representation and Chords:** A point on a circle of radius r centered at the origin is $\mathbf{x} = r \begin{pmatrix} \cos \alpha \\ \sin \alpha \end{pmatrix}$ with $\mathbf{e}_\alpha \begin{pmatrix} \cos \alpha \\ \sin \alpha \end{pmatrix}$. The chord length between $\mathbf{x}_\alpha = r \mathbf{e}_\alpha$ and $\mathbf{x}_\beta = r \mathbf{e}_\beta$ satisfies:

$$\mathbf{e}_\alpha^\top \mathbf{e}_\beta = \cos(\alpha - \beta) \quad (1.1.2.5)$$

$$\|\mathbf{x}_\alpha - \mathbf{x}_\beta\|^2 = 2r^2 (1 - \mathbf{e}_\alpha^\top \mathbf{e}_\beta) = 4r^2 \sin^2 \frac{\alpha - \beta}{2} \quad (1.1.2.6)$$

1.1.3 System of Linear Equations and Rouché–Capelli Theorem

- **Consistency and Solvability:** A system

$$\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}, \quad \mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n} \quad (1.1.3.1)$$

is consistent if and only if

$$\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = \text{rank}(\mathbf{A} \mid \mathbf{b}) = r \quad (1.1.3.2)$$

If $r = n$, the solution is unique; if $r < n$, there exist infinitely many solutions with $n - r$ free variables. If $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times (n-1)}$, the system is consistent only if

$$|\mathbf{A} \mid \mathbf{b}| = 0 \quad (1.1.3.3)$$

- Homogeneous System and Zero Norm Property: For $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 3}$ with rank 2, the solution of $\mathbf{Ax} = \mathbf{0}$ is given by the cross product of its rows:

$$\mathbf{x} = \kappa(\mathbf{a}_1 \times \mathbf{a}_2) \quad (1.1.3.4)$$

For any vector $\mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^n$,

$$\|\mathbf{v}\|^2 = \mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{v} = \sum_i v_i^2 = 0 \iff \mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0} \quad (1.1.3.5)$$

1.1.4 Determinants and Cofactor Expansion

- Expansion Along a Row: For $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$, expanding along row i with minor M_{ij} (the determinant after deleting row i and column j):

$$|\mathbf{A}| = \sum_{j=1}^n (-1)^{i+j} a_{ij} M_{ij} \quad (1.1.4.1)$$

For a 2×2 matrix:

$$\begin{vmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{vmatrix} = ad - bc \quad (1.1.4.2)$$

1.1.5 Relation Between Eigenvalues and Trace of a Matrix

- Characteristic Polynomial and Trace Relation: The characteristic polynomial of $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ is

$$P(\lambda) = |\lambda \mathbf{I} - \mathbf{A}| \quad (1.1.5.1)$$

The sum of all eigenvalues equals the trace of the matrix:

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i = \sum_{i=1}^n a_{ii} = \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}) \quad (1.1.5.2)$$

A matrix is symmetric if $\mathbf{A}^\top = \mathbf{A}$ and skew-symmetric if $\mathbf{A}^\top = -\mathbf{A}$.

1.1.6 Cholesky Decomposition

- Factorization: A symmetric positive definite matrix $\mathbf{A}$ can be factorized as:

$$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{LL}^\top \quad (1.1.6.1)$$

where $\mathbf{L}$ is lower triangular with positive diagonal elements.

- General Formulas for Entries of $\mathbf{L}$:

$$\text{Diagonal entries: } l_{jj} = \sqrt{a_{jj} - \sum_{k=1}^{j-1} l_{jk}^2} \quad (1.1.6.2)$$

$$\text{Off-diagonal entries } (i > j): \quad l_{ij} = \frac{1}{l_{jj}} \left(a_{ij} - \sum_{k=1}^{j-1} l_{ik} l_{jk} \right) \quad (1.1.6.3)$$

- 2×2 Decomposition Form:

$$\begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} \\ a_{12} & a_{22} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} l_{11} & 0 \\ l_{21} & l_{22} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} l_{11} & l_{21} \\ 0 & l_{22} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} l_{11}^2 & l_{11}l_{21} \\ l_{11}l_{21} & l_{21}^2 + l_{22}^2 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.1.6.4)$$

1.1.7 Bayes' Theorem in Vector Form

- Vector Formulation: Given prior vector $\pi = (\Pr(B_1) \quad \dots \quad \Pr(B_n))^\top$ and likelihood vector $\mathbf{l} = (\Pr(E | B_1) \quad \dots \quad \Pr(E | B_n))^\top$:

$$\Pr(E) = \pi^\top \mathbf{l} \quad (1.1.7.1)$$

$$\Pr(B_i | E) = \frac{\pi_i l_i}{\pi^\top \mathbf{l}} \quad (1.1.7.2)$$

1.1.8 Minimization via Completing the Square

- Inequality and Equality Condition: For real a and b :

$$ab - b^2 = \frac{a^2}{4} - \left(b - \frac{a}{2}\right)^2 \leq \frac{a^2}{4} \quad (1.1.8.1)$$

with equality holding if and only if $b = \frac{a}{2}$.

- Zero Integral Property: If $g(x) \geq 0$ is continuous on $[a, b]$ and $\int_a^b g(x) dx = 0$, then

$$g(x) = 0 \text{ on } [a, b] \quad (1.1.8.2)$$

1.1.9 Laplace Transform and State-Space Form

- Transform Operational Properties:

$$y'(t) \xleftrightarrow{\mathcal{L}} sY(s) - y(0) \quad (1.1.9.1)$$

$$y''(t) \xleftrightarrow{\mathcal{L}} s^2Y(s) - sy(0) - y'(0) \quad (1.1.9.2)$$

$$e^{at}u(t) \xleftrightarrow{\mathcal{L}} \frac{1}{s-a} \quad (1.1.9.3)$$

- State-Space Representation: Writing $\mathbf{z} = \begin{pmatrix} y \\ y' \end{pmatrix}^\top$, the ODE $y'' + py' + qy = 0$ becomes $\mathbf{z}' = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{z}$ where:

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -q & -p \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.1.9.4)$$

The exponents of the solution are the eigenvalues of $\mathbf{A}$.

1.1.10 Newton-Raphson Method

- First-Order Recurrence: For a differentiable function $f(x)$, the root is iteratively approximated by:

$$x_{n+1} = x_n - \frac{f(x_n)}{f'(x_n)} \quad (1.1.10.1)$$

1.1.11 Polynomial Interpolation (Vandermonde Matrix)

- Matrix Form: The polynomial $P_2(x) = c_0 + c_1x + c_2x^2$ through points (x_i, y_i) for $i = 1, 2, 3$ satisfies:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 & x_1^2 \\ 1 & x_2 & x_2^2 \\ 1 & x_3 & x_3^2 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} c_0 \\ c_1 \\ c_2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} y_1 \\ y_2 \\ y_3 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.1.11.1)$$

1.1.12 Equilibrium of Rigid Bodies in Vector Form

- Force and Moment Equilibrium: For a body in equilibrium under forces $\mathbf{F}_i$ acting at points $\mathbf{r}_i$:

$$\sum_i \mathbf{F}_i = \mathbf{0}, \quad \sum_i (\mathbf{r}_i - \mathbf{O}) \times \mathbf{F}_i = \mathbf{0} \quad (1.1.12.1)$$

where in the 2D plane, $\mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{F} = r_x F_y - r_y F_x$.

- Bending Moment and Friction: The bending moment at section P is

$$M(P) = \sum_{\text{one side}} (\mathbf{r}_i - \mathbf{P}) \times \mathbf{F}_i \quad (1.1.12.2)$$

The limiting friction force is

$$F = \mu N \quad (1.1.12.3)$$

1.1.13 Direct Stiffness Method

- Member and Global Stiffness Formulation: For an axial member of length L , area A , modulus E , and direction vector $\mathbf{m}$, the nodal stiffness is

$$\mathbf{k} = \frac{AE}{L} \mathbf{m} \mathbf{m}^\top \quad (1.1.13.1)$$

and the member stiffness matrix is $\begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{k} & -\mathbf{k} \\ -\mathbf{k} & \mathbf{k} \end{pmatrix}$. The global system is

$$\mathbf{K} \mathbf{u} = \mathbf{F} \quad (1.1.13.2)$$

- Thermal Load Equivalence: A temperature rise ΔT with expansion coefficient α produces equivalent nodal loads of $AE\alpha\Delta T$ at member ends directed outward.

1.1.14 Free Thermal Expansion

- Thermal Strain and Elongation: A temperature change ΔT in an unrestrained member of length L with coefficient of thermal expansion α produces thermal strain ϵ_{th} and free thermal elongation ΔL :

$$\Delta L = L\alpha\Delta T \quad (1.1.14.1)$$

1.1.15 Cellular Update Rule in Matrix Form

- Matrix Formulation: For N bulbs in a line with state vector $\mathbf{x}_k \in \{0, 1\}^N$, the number of ON neighbours is given by $\mathbf{s}_k = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}_k$ with:

$$a_{ij} = \begin{cases} 1, & |i - j| = 1 \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \quad (1.1.15.1)$$

B. Problems

1.2.1 At how many points will the curves $y = x^2$ and $y = -x^2 - 2x - 1$ intersect in the real (x, y) plane? (GATE CE 2026)

a) 0

b) 1

c) 2

d) 3

Solution: Writing both curves in the form (1.1.1.1),

$$x^2 - y = 0 \implies \mathbf{V}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{u}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -\frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix}, f_1 = 0 \quad (1.2.1.1)$$

$$x^2 + 2x + y + 1 = 0 \implies \mathbf{V}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{u}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ \frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix}, f_2 = 1 \quad (1.2.1.2)$$

Here $\mathbf{V}_1 = \mathbf{V}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ already has a zero row, so it is singular (its rank is $1 < 2$) and both curves are parabolas. Any common point lies on every member of the pencil (1.1.1.9):

$$\mathbf{x}^\top \begin{pmatrix} 1 + \mu & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{x} + 2 \begin{pmatrix} \mu \\ \frac{\mu-1}{2} \end{pmatrix}^\top \mathbf{x} + \mu = 0 \quad (1.2.1.3)$$

The pencil is degenerate when its 3×3 coefficient matrix (the second-degree, linear and constant coefficients of the pencil arranged symmetrically) is singular, which happens exactly when its row reduced form has a zero row. For $\mu \neq -1$, interchanging R_2 and R_3 and then applying $R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - \frac{\mu}{1+\mu} R_1$,

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 + \mu & 0 & \mu \\ 0 & 0 & \frac{\mu-1}{2} \\ \mu & \frac{\mu-1}{2} & \mu \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_2 \leftrightarrow R_3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 + \mu & 0 & \mu \\ \mu & \frac{\mu-1}{2} & \mu \\ 0 & 0 & \frac{\mu-1}{2} \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.1.4)$$

$$\xrightarrow{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - \frac{\mu}{1+\mu} R_1} \begin{pmatrix} 1 + \mu & 0 & \mu \\ 0 & \frac{\mu-1}{2} & \frac{\mu}{1+\mu} \\ 0 & 0 & \frac{\mu-1}{2} \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.1.5)$$

The matrix is upper triangular, so it has a zero row only if a diagonal entry is zero, and for $\mu \neq -1$ this gives $\mu = 1$. For $\mu = -1$ the matrix is

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 \\ -1 & -1 & -1 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - R_1} \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & -1 & -1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.1.6)$$

which has a zero row. Hence the pencil is degenerate for $\mu = -1$ and $\mu = 1$. For $\mu = -1$, $\mathbf{V}_1 - \mathbf{V}_2 = \mathbf{0}$ and the second-degree terms vanish. From (1.1.1.11),

$$2(\mathbf{u}_1 - \mathbf{u}_2)^\top \mathbf{x} + (f_1 - f_2) = 0 \quad (1.2.1.7)$$

$$2 \begin{pmatrix} -1 & -1 \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{x} - 1 = 0 \implies \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{x} = -\frac{1}{2} \quad (1.2.1.8)$$

The normal vector is $\mathbf{n} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$. From (1.1.2.2) and (1.1.2.1), a point on the line and its direction vector are

$$\mathbf{h} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -\frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{m} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{h} + \kappa \mathbf{m} \quad (1.2.1.9)$$

Substituting this line into the first parabola using (1.1.1.8) and (1.1.1.5),

$$\mathbf{m}^\top \mathbf{V}_1 \mathbf{m} = (1 \quad -1) \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} = 1 \quad (1.2.1.10)$$

$$\mathbf{V}_1 \mathbf{h} + \mathbf{u}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -\frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -\frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -\frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.1.11)$$

$$\mathbf{m}^\top (\mathbf{V}_1 \mathbf{h} + \mathbf{u}_1) = (1 \quad -1) \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -\frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix} = \frac{1}{2} \quad (1.2.1.12)$$

$$g(\mathbf{h}) = \mathbf{h}^\top \mathbf{V}_1 \mathbf{h} + 2\mathbf{u}_1^\top \mathbf{h} + f_1 = 0 + \frac{1}{2} + 0 = \frac{1}{2} \quad (1.2.1.13)$$

which gives

$$\kappa^2 + \kappa + \frac{1}{2} = 0 \quad (1.2.1.14)$$

The discriminant from (1.1.1.6) is

$$\Delta = [\mathbf{m}^\top (\mathbf{V}_1 \mathbf{h} + \mathbf{u}_1)]^2 - g(\mathbf{h}) (\mathbf{m}^\top \mathbf{V}_1 \mathbf{m}) = \frac{1}{4} - \frac{1}{2} = -\frac{1}{4} < 0 \quad (1.2.1.15)$$

From (1.1.1.4),

$$\kappa = -\frac{1}{2} \pm \frac{j}{2} \quad (1.2.1.16)$$

which is not real (here j is i). As a check, the other degenerate member $\mu = 1$ gives

$$(x^2 - y) + (x^2 + 2x + y + 1) = 2x^2 + 2x + 1 = 0 \implies x = \frac{-1 \pm j}{2} \quad (1.2.1.17)$$

which is again not real. Hence the curves do not meet in the real (x, y) plane and the number of intersection points is 0.

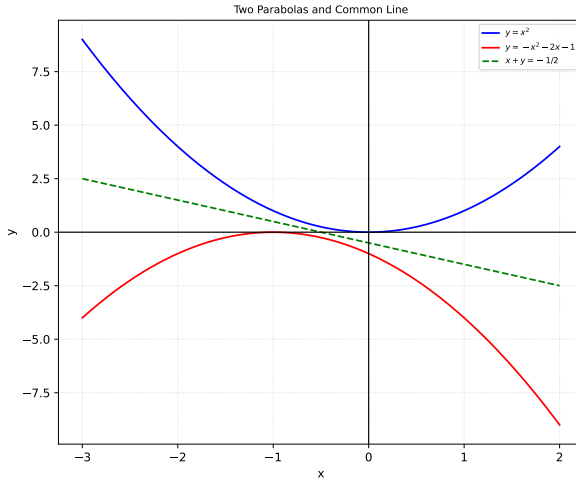


Fig. 1.2.1.1. The two parabolas and the line $x + y = -\frac{1}{2}$ from the pencil

codes/ce1q3/q03.py

codes/ce1q3/q03plot.py

1.2.2 In the given figure, $\overline{PQ}$ is the diameter of a circle with center O . Two points R and S are chosen on the circle such that $\angle ROS = 80^\circ$. When $\overline{PR}$ and $\overline{QS}$ are extended, they meet at T . The value of $\angle RTS$ is _____ (GATE CE 2026)

- a) 40° b) 50° c) 60° d) 80°

Solution: Let O be the origin and the radius be r , with the diameter PQ along the x -axis. As in the figure, R and S lie on the same side of PQ (taken above it) and T lies beyond both R and S . Here $\mathbf{i}$ is the unit vector along the positive x -axis, and $\mathbf{w}_\theta$ is the unit vector that makes an angle θ with the positive x -axis, i.e. the point of the unit circle at angle θ :

$$\mathbf{i} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{w}_\theta \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta \\ \sin \theta \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.2.1)$$

Since PQ is a diameter, $\mathbf{P}$ and $\mathbf{Q}$ are opposite points on the x -axis. Let $\mathbf{R} = r\mathbf{w}_\alpha$ and $\mathbf{S} = r\mathbf{w}_\beta$ with $0 < \beta < \alpha < 180^\circ$. The points are listed in Table 1.2.2.

Point	Vector	Description
O	$\mathbf{0}$	centre
P	$-r\mathbf{i}$	end of diameter
Q	$r\mathbf{i}$	end of diameter
R	$r\mathbf{w}_\alpha$	on the circle
S	$r\mathbf{w}_\beta$	on the circle

TABLE 1.2.2

CONSTRUCTION MATRIX OF THE POINTS

The construction matrix is

$$(\mathbf{P} \quad \mathbf{Q} \quad \mathbf{R} \quad \mathbf{S}) = r \begin{pmatrix} -\mathbf{i} & \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{w}_\alpha & \mathbf{w}_\beta \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.2.2)$$

From (1.1.2.5),

$$\cos \angle ROS = \mathbf{w}_\alpha^\top \mathbf{w}_\beta = \cos(\alpha - \beta) \implies \alpha - \beta = 80^\circ \quad (1.2.2.3)$$

The direction vectors of the lines PR and QS are

$$\mathbf{R} - \mathbf{P} = r \begin{pmatrix} 1 + \cos \alpha \\ \sin \alpha \end{pmatrix} = 2r \cos \frac{\alpha}{2} \begin{pmatrix} \cos \frac{\alpha}{2} \\ \sin \frac{\alpha}{2} \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.2.4)$$

$$\mathbf{S} - \mathbf{Q} = r \begin{pmatrix} \cos \beta - 1 \\ \sin \beta \end{pmatrix} = 2r \sin \frac{\beta}{2} \begin{pmatrix} -\sin \frac{\beta}{2} \\ \cos \frac{\beta}{2} \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.2.5)$$

The point T lies beyond R on PR and beyond S on QS . Hence $\overrightarrow{TR}$ is along $\mathbf{P} - \mathbf{R}$ and $\overrightarrow{TS}$ is along $\mathbf{Q} - \mathbf{S}$. Using (1.1.2.4),

$$\cos \angle RTS = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \frac{\alpha}{2} & \sin \frac{\alpha}{2} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} -\sin \frac{\beta}{2} \\ \cos \frac{\beta}{2} \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.2.6)$$

$$= \sin \frac{\alpha}{2} \cos \frac{\beta}{2} - \cos \frac{\alpha}{2} \sin \frac{\beta}{2} = \sin \frac{\alpha - \beta}{2} \quad (1.2.2.7)$$

$$= \sin 40^\circ = \cos 50^\circ \quad (1.2.2.8)$$

$$\implies \angle RTS = 50^\circ \quad (1.2.2.9)$$

For a numerical check, take $r = 1$, $\alpha = 130^\circ$, $\beta = 50^\circ$. From (1.1.2.3),

$$(\mathbf{R} - \mathbf{P} \quad -(\mathbf{S} - \mathbf{Q})) \begin{pmatrix} \kappa_1 \\ \kappa_2 \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{Q} - \mathbf{P} \implies \mathbf{T} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 2.1445 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.2.10)$$

and (1.1.2.4) gives $\angle RTS = 50^\circ$.

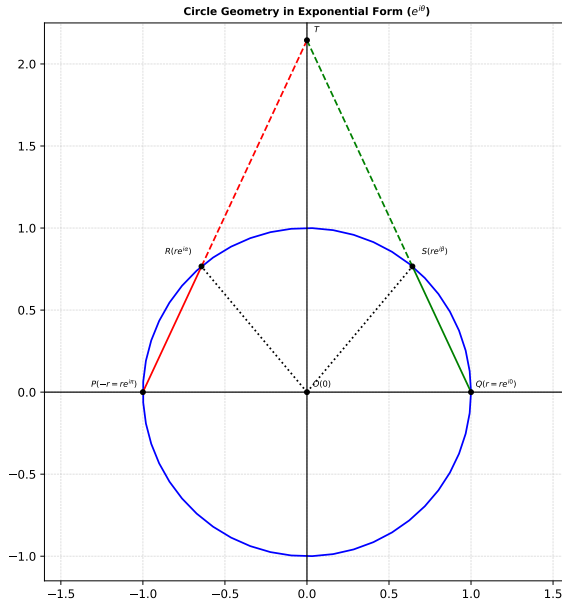


Fig. 1.2.2.1. Circle with diameter PQ , $\angle ROS = 80^\circ$ and $\angle RTS = 50^\circ$

`codes/ce1q7/q07.py`

`codes/ce1q7/q07plot.py`

- 1.2.3 Consider a linear arrangement of seven bulbs, each of which can be in the ON or OFF states. The initial configuration of the bulbs is shown in the figure. In every Step, the states of the bulbs are changed based on the following rules: Any OFF bulb with exactly one ON neighbor at the end of the previous Step is turned ON. Any ON bulb with both neighbors ON at the end of the previous Step is turned OFF. The state of any bulb not meeting the conditions above is left unchanged. The state of bulbs at the end of Step 1 and Step 2 are also shown in the figure. The number of bulbs which are ON at the end of Step 8 is (GATE CE 2026)

a) 5

b) 4

c) 3

d) 0

Initial



Step 1 ↓



○ ON

Step 2 ↓

● OFF



Solution: Let $x_k \in \{0, 1\}^7$ be the state vector after Step k and $s_k = Ax_k$, where, from (1.1.15.1),

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

The rules give the update:

$$x_{k+1} = x_k + (1 - x_k) \odot [s_k = 1] - x_k \odot [s_k = 2]$$

where $\odot$ is the element-wise product and $[\cdot]$ is 1 when the condition holds. The initial configuration has only the middle bulb ON:

$$x_0 = (0 \ 0 \ 0 \ 1 \ 0 \ 0 \ 0)^\top, \quad s_0 = (0 \ 0 \ 1 \ 0 \ 1 \ 0 \ 0)^\top$$

$$x_1 = (0 \ 0 \ 1 \ 1 \ 1 \ 0 \ 0)^\top, \quad s_1 = (0 \ 1 \ 1 \ 2 \ 1 \ 1 \ 0)^\top$$

$$x_2 = (0 \ 1 \ 1 \ 0 \ 1 \ 1 \ 0)^\top, \quad s_2 = (1 \ 1 \ 1 \ 2 \ 1 \ 1 \ 1)^\top$$

$$x_3 = (1 \ 1 \ 1 \ 0 \ 1 \ 1 \ 1)^\top, \quad s_3 = (1 \ 2 \ 1 \ 2 \ 1 \ 2 \ 1)^\top$$

$$x_4 = (1 \ 0 \ 1 \ 0 \ 1 \ 0 \ 1)^\top, \quad s_4 = (0 \ 2 \ 0 \ 2 \ 0 \ 2 \ 0)^\top$$

x_1 and x_2 agree with Step 1 and Step 2 in the figure. In x_4 , every OFF bulb has two ON neighbours and every ON bulb has none, so:

$$x_5 = x_4 \Rightarrow x_8 = x_4 = (1 \ 0 \ 1 \ 0 \ 1 \ 0 \ 1)^\top$$

The number of bulbs which are ON at the end of Step 8 is:

$$1^\top x_8 = 4$$

1.2.4 P and Q are two positive integers such that $P^2 = Q^2 + 13$. The product of the numbers P and Q is _____ (GATE CE 2026)

a) 13

b) 26

c) 39

d) 42

Solution: The given equation can be written as

$$P^2 - Q^2 = (P - Q)(P + Q) = 13 \quad (1.2.4.1)$$

Since 13 is prime and $0 < P - Q < P + Q$,

$$P - Q = 1, \quad P + Q = 13 \quad (1.2.4.2)$$

Let

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 13 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{x} = \begin{pmatrix} P \\ Q \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.4.3)$$

Expressing in the matrix form (1.1.3.1):

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} P \\ Q \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 13 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.4.4)$$

Reducing the augmented matrix:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 13 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - R_1} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 1 \\ 0 & 2 & 12 \end{pmatrix} \Rightarrow Q = 6, P = 7 \quad (1.2.4.5)$$

From (1.1.3.2), $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = \text{rank}(\mathbf{A} | \mathbf{b}) = 2 = n$, so the solution is unique. Therefore,

$$PQ = 7 \times 6 = 42 \quad (1.2.4.6)$$

codes/ce1q10/q10.py

1.2.5 Matrix $\mathbf{P}$ is given as

$$\mathbf{P} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.5.1)$$

The TRUE option is

(GATE CE 2026)

- a) Trace of $\mathbf{P}$ is equal to the sum of the Eigen values of $\mathbf{P}$.
 b) $\mathbf{P}^\top \mathbf{P}$ is an identity matrix.
 c) $\mathbf{P}$ is a skew-symmetric matrix.
 d) Absolute magnitude of each Eigen value is 1.

Solution: A scalar λ is an eigenvalue of $\mathbf{P}$ when $\lambda \mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P}$ is singular, i.e. when its row reduced form has a zero row. Interchanging R_1 and R_3 and then applying

$$R_3 \rightarrow R_3 + (\lambda - 1) R_1,$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} \lambda - 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & \lambda - 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & \lambda - 1 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_1 \leftrightarrow R_3} \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 & \lambda - 1 \\ 0 & \lambda - 1 & 0 \\ \lambda - 1 & 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.5.2)$$

$$\xrightarrow{R_3 \rightarrow R_3 + (\lambda - 1) R_1} \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 & \lambda - 1 \\ 0 & \lambda - 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & (\lambda - 1)^2 - 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.5.3)$$

The matrix is upper triangular, so it is singular only if a diagonal entry is zero:

$$\lambda - 1 = 0 \quad \text{or} \quad (\lambda - 1)^2 - 1 = \lambda(\lambda - 2) = 0 \implies \lambda_1 = 0, \lambda_2 = 1, \lambda_3 = 2 \quad (1.2.5.4)$$

From (1.1.5.2):

$$\text{tr}(\mathbf{P}) = 1 + 1 + 1 = 3 = \lambda_1 + \lambda_2 + \lambda_3 \quad (1.2.5.5)$$

so option (a) is true. The remaining options are false since

$$\mathbf{P}^\top \mathbf{P} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \neq \mathbf{I} \quad (1.2.5.6)$$

$$\mathbf{P}^\top = \mathbf{P} \neq -\mathbf{P} \quad (1.2.5.7)$$

$$|\lambda_1| = 0 \neq 1 \quad (1.2.5.8)$$

codes/ce1q11/q11.py

1.2.6 Given:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.6.1)$$

The above system of equations represents a (GATE CE 2026)

- a) plane b) line c) volume d) point

Solution: Reducing the given system:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \implies \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.6.2)$$

This gives:

$$x_1 + 2x_3 = 0 \quad (1.2.6.3)$$

$$-x_2 + x_3 = 0 \quad (1.2.6.4)$$

Expressing the solution vector $\mathbf{x}$:

$$\begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -2x_3 \\ x_3 \\ x_3 \end{pmatrix} = x_3 \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.6.5)$$

which represents a line passing through the origin. As a check, the rows of the coefficient matrix are $\mathbf{a}_1 = (1 \ 1 \ 1)^\top$ and $\mathbf{a}_2 = (1 \ 0 \ 2)^\top$ with rank 2, so from (1.1.3.4)

$$\mathbf{x} = \kappa (\mathbf{a}_1 \times \mathbf{a}_2) = \kappa \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.6.6)$$

which is the same line. Since $n - r = 3 - 2 = 1$ by (1.1.3.2), there is one free variable, so the solution set is a line. Hence the correct option is (b).

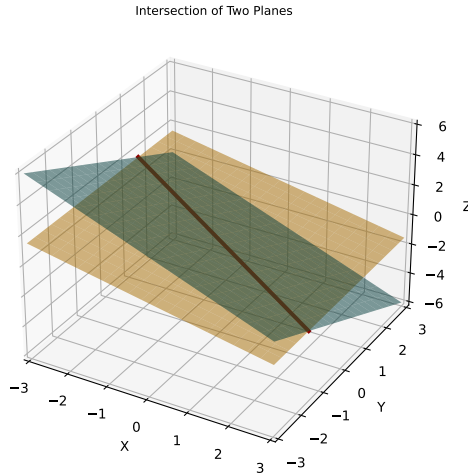


Fig. 1.2.6.1. The two planes and their line of intersection

codes/ce1q12/q12.py

codes/ce1q12/q12plot.py

- 1.2.7 Bag I contains 4 white and 6 black balls. Bag II contains 4 white and 3 black balls. One ball is drawn at random from any one of the two bags and it is found to be a black ball. The probability that the black ball was drawn from Bag I is _____ (rounded off to two decimal places). (GATE CE 2026)

Solution: Let B_1 , B_2 denote choosing Bag I, Bag II and E the event of drawing a black ball. The prior and likelihood vectors are

$$\pi = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{1} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{6}{19} \\ \frac{7}{7} \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.7.1)$$

From (1.1.7.1),

$$\Pr(E) = \pi^\top \mathbf{1} = \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{3}{5} + \frac{3}{7} \right) = \frac{18}{35} \quad (1.2.7.2)$$

From (1.1.7.2),

$$\Pr(B_1 | E) = \frac{\frac{1}{2} \times \frac{3}{5}}{\frac{18}{35}} = \frac{3}{10} \times \frac{35}{18} = \frac{7}{12} \approx 0.58 \quad (1.2.7.3)$$

codes/ce1q26/q26.py

1.2.8 A matrix is given as:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 9 & 15 \\ 15 & 50 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.8.1)$$

By performing Cholesky decomposition, $|l_{22}|$ of the lower triangular matrix is _____ (in integer). (GATE CE 2026)

Solution: Let

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{pmatrix} 9 & 15 \\ 15 & 50 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.8.2)$$

Cholesky decomposition applies to a square, symmetric, positive definite matrix. Here $\mathbf{A}^\top = \mathbf{A}$ and, by row reduction,

$$\begin{pmatrix} 9 & 15 \\ 15 & 50 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - \frac{5}{3}R_1} \begin{pmatrix} 9 & 15 \\ 0 & 25 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.8.3)$$

Both pivots 9 and 25 are positive, so $\mathbf{A}$ is positive definite and, from (1.1.6.1), can be written as $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{L}\mathbf{L}^\top$, where $\mathbf{L}$ is lower triangular with positive diagonal entries. For a general $n \times n$ matrix, the entries of $\mathbf{L}$ are found column by column using (1.1.6.2) and (1.1.6.3). For $n = 2$, these reduce to (1.1.6.4):

$$\begin{pmatrix} 9 & 15 \\ 15 & 50 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} l_{11} & 0 \\ l_{21} & l_{22} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} l_{11} & l_{21} \\ 0 & l_{22} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} l_{11}^2 & l_{11}l_{21} \\ l_{11}l_{21} & l_{21}^2 + l_{22}^2 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.8.4)$$

Comparing the entries in (1.2.8.4) one at a time:

$$\text{Entry } (1,1): l_{11}^2 = 9 \implies l_{11} = 3 \quad (1.2.8.5)$$

$$\text{Entry } (2,1): l_{11}l_{21} = 15 \implies l_{21} = \frac{15}{3} = 5 \quad (1.2.8.6)$$

$$\text{Entry } (2,2): l_{21}^2 + l_{22}^2 = 50 \implies l_{22}^2 = 50 - 25 = 25 \implies l_{22} = 5 \quad (1.2.8.7)$$

These are the same as (1.1.6.2) with $j = 1$, (1.1.6.3) with $i = 2$, $j = 1$, and

(1.1.6.2) with $j = 2$. Thus,

$$\mathbf{L} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 5 & 5 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{L}\mathbf{L}^\top = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 5 & 5 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 5 \\ 0 & 5 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 9 & 15 \\ 15 & 50 \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{A} \quad (1.2.8.8)$$

As a check, the pivots 9 and 25 in (1.2.8.3) are l_{11}^2 and l_{22}^2 , which agrees with $l_{11} = 3$ and $l_{22} = 5$. Hence,

$$|l_{22}| = 5 \quad (1.2.8.9)$$

codes/ce1q27/q27.py

1.2.9 It is given that x and y are integers in the following equation:

$$(x + y - 7)^2 + (y + 3x - 13)^2 = 0 \quad (1.2.9.1)$$

The value of $(x^3 + y^3)$ is _____ (in integer). (GATE CE 2026)

Solution: Let the two lines be

$$L_1 : x + y - 7 = 0, \quad L_2 : 3x + y - 13 = 0 \quad (1.2.9.2)$$

Each squared line is a degenerate conic of the form (1.1.1.1):

$$(x + y - 7)^2 = 0 \implies \mathbf{V}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{u}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} -7 \\ -7 \end{pmatrix}, \quad f_1 = 49 \quad (1.2.9.3)$$

$$(3x + y - 13)^2 = 0 \implies \mathbf{V}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 9 & 3 \\ 3 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{u}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} -39 \\ -13 \end{pmatrix}, \quad f_2 = 169 \quad (1.2.9.4)$$

The given equation is the member $\mu = 1$ of the pencil (1.1.1.9):

$$\mathbf{V} = \mathbf{V}_1 + \mathbf{V}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 10 & 4 \\ 4 & 2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{u} = \mathbf{u}_1 + \mathbf{u}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} -46 \\ -20 \end{pmatrix}, \quad f = f_1 + f_2 = 218 \quad (1.2.9.5)$$

Writing $\tilde{\mathbf{x}} = \begin{pmatrix} x & y & 1 \end{pmatrix}^\top$, the conic becomes

$$\tilde{\mathbf{x}}^\top \mathbf{M} \tilde{\mathbf{x}} = 0, \quad \mathbf{M} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{V} & \mathbf{u} \\ \mathbf{u}^\top & f \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 10 & 4 & -46 \\ 4 & 2 & -20 \\ -46 & -20 & 218 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.9.6)$$

Reducing $\mathbf{M}$ by row operations (the multipliers 5 in $R_2 \rightarrow 5R_2 - 2R_1$ and $R_3 \rightarrow 5R_3 + 23R_1$ are chosen to cancel the first column without introducing fractions; they only rescale the rows, so the rank is unchanged):

$$\begin{pmatrix} 10 & 4 & -46 \\ 4 & 2 & -20 \\ -46 & -20 & 218 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow[R_3 \rightarrow 5R_3 + 23R_1]{R_2 \rightarrow 5R_2 - 2R_1} \begin{pmatrix} 10 & 4 & -46 \\ 0 & 2 & -8 \\ 0 & -8 & 32 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.9.7)$$

$$\xrightarrow{R_3 \rightarrow R_3 + 4R_2} \begin{pmatrix} 10 & 4 & -46 \\ 0 & 2 & -8 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.9.8)$$

The last row is zero, so $\text{rank}(\mathbf{M}) = 2 < 3$, i.e. $\mathbf{M}$ is singular, so the conic is

degenerate. Row reducing $\mathbf{V}$,

$$\begin{pmatrix} 10 & 4 \\ 4 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - \frac{2}{5}R_1} \begin{pmatrix} 10 & 4 \\ 0 & \frac{2}{5} \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.9.9)$$

Both pivots are positive, so $\mathbf{V}$ is positive definite and the conic is an ellipse. Hence it is a degenerate ellipse, i.e. a single point. To find this point, note that

$$\mathbf{M} = \mathbf{B}^\top \mathbf{B}, \quad \mathbf{B} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & -7 \\ 3 & 1 & -13 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.9.10)$$

so the given equation is

$$\tilde{\mathbf{x}}^\top \mathbf{M} \tilde{\mathbf{x}} = \|\mathbf{B} \tilde{\mathbf{x}}\|^2 = 0 \quad (1.2.9.11)$$

From (1.1.3.5), $\mathbf{B} \tilde{\mathbf{x}} = \mathbf{0}$, hence $\mathbf{M} \tilde{\mathbf{x}} = \mathbf{B}^\top \mathbf{B} \tilde{\mathbf{x}} = \mathbf{0}$. Using the reduced form of $\mathbf{M}$,

$$\begin{pmatrix} 10 & 4 & -46 \\ 0 & 2 & -8 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{0} \quad (1.2.9.12)$$

$$\implies 2y - 8 = 0, \quad 10x + 4y - 46 = 0 \implies y = 4, \quad x = 3 \quad (1.2.9.13)$$

Therefore,

$$x^3 + y^3 = 27 + 64 = 91 \quad (1.2.9.14)$$

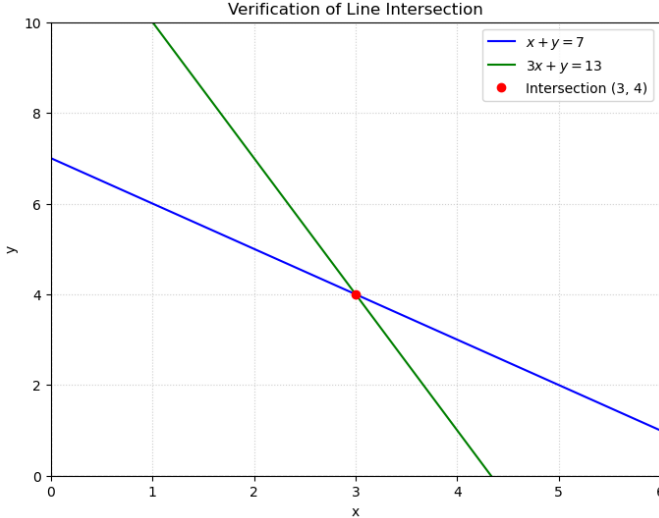


Fig. 1.2.9.1. The lines $x + y = 7$ and $3x + y = 13$ meet at $(3, 4)$

1.2.10 Let $f(x)$ be a continuous function defined in $[0, 2] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ and satisfying the equation

$$\int_0^2 f(x) [x - f(x)] dx = \frac{2}{3} \quad (1.2.10.1)$$

The value of $f(1)$ is (GATE CE 2026)

- a) 1 b) 2 c) $\frac{1}{2}$ d) 0

Solution: Using (1.1.8.1) with $a = x$ and $b = f(x)$:

$$f(x) [x - f(x)] = \frac{x^2}{4} - \left(f(x) - \frac{x}{2}\right)^2 \quad (1.2.10.2)$$

Integrating over $[0, 2]$:

$$\int_0^2 f(x) [x - f(x)] dx = \int_0^2 \frac{x^2}{4} dx - \int_0^2 \left(f(x) - \frac{x}{2}\right)^2 dx \quad (1.2.10.3)$$

$$= \frac{2}{3} - \int_0^2 \left(f(x) - \frac{x}{2}\right)^2 dx \quad (1.2.10.4)$$

Equating with the given value,

$$\int_0^2 \left(f(x) - \frac{x}{2}\right)^2 dx = 0 \quad (1.2.10.5)$$

Since the integrand is continuous and non-negative, the zero integral property (1.1.8.2) gives

$$f(x) = \frac{x}{2} \implies f(1) = \frac{1}{2} \quad (1.2.10.6)$$

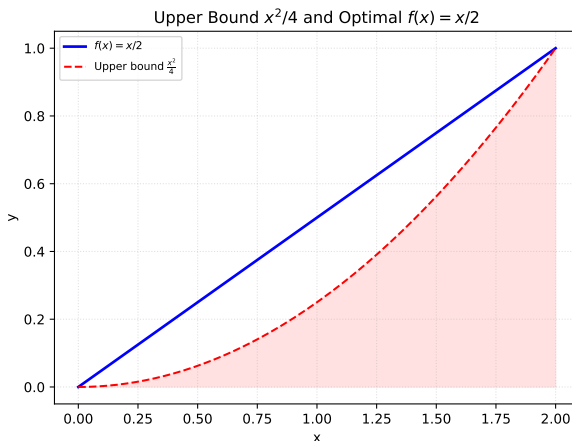


Fig. 1.2.10.1. The integrand attains its upper bound $\frac{x^2}{4}$ only for $f(x) = \frac{x}{2}$

codes/ce1q36/q36.py

codes/ce1q36/q36plot.py

1.2.11 An ordinary differential equation is given below.

$$x^2 \frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} = 6y \quad (1.2.11.1)$$

Considering a and b as arbitrary constants, the general solution of the equation is (GATE CE 2026)

a) $y(x) = ax^3 + \frac{b}{x^2}$
b) $y(x) = ax^2 + \frac{b}{x^3}$

c) $y(x) = ax^2 + b \ln x$
d) $y(x) = ax^3 + b \ln x$

Solution: The equation is of Cauchy–Euler type, so we take $x > 0$ and let $x = e^t$, which maps $x > 0$ onto all real t . Then

$$x \frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{dy}{dt}, \quad x^2 \frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} = \frac{d^2 y}{dt^2} - \frac{dy}{dt} \quad (1.2.11.2)$$

and the equation becomes

$$y'' - y' - 6y = 0 \quad (1.2.11.3)$$

Taking the Laplace transform using (1.1.9.1) and (1.1.9.2):

$$s^2 Y(s) - sy(0) - y'(0) - [sY(s) - y(0)] - 6Y(s) = 0 \quad (1.2.11.4)$$

$$Y(s) = \frac{(s-1)y(0) + y'(0)}{s^2 - s - 6} = \frac{(s-1)y(0) + y'(0)}{(s-3)(s+2)} \quad (1.2.11.5)$$

Decomposing into partial fractions and using (1.1.9.3),

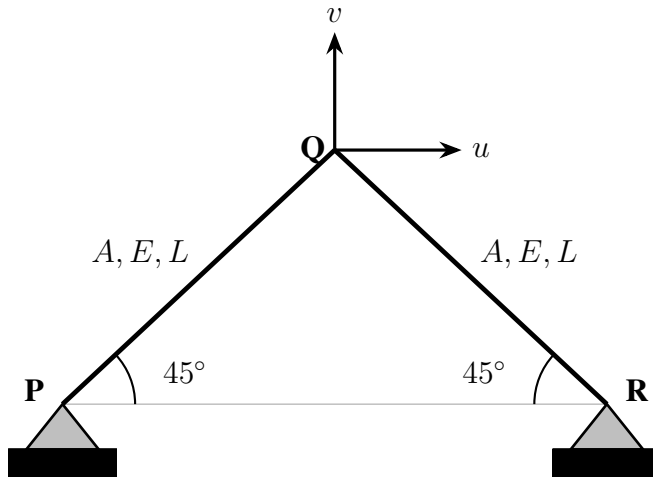
$$Y(s) = \frac{a}{s-3} + \frac{b}{s+2} \implies y(t) = ae^{3t} + be^{-2t} \quad (1.2.11.6)$$

The Laplace transform is applied to $y(t)$ for $t \geq 0$ only to identify the exponents 3 and -2 and the form of the solution. This form does not depend on the starting point, and $y = ax^3 + bx^{-2}$ satisfies the ODE for every $x > 0$ (for example, $x^2 y'' = 6ax^3 + 6bx^{-2} = 6y$). Substituting $e^t = x$:

$$y(x) = ax^3 + \frac{b}{x^2} \quad (1.2.11.7)$$

codes/ce1q37/q37.py

- 1.2.12 A plane truss consists of two linearly elastic, homogeneous, identical members, namely PQ and QR . Both members have length (L), cross-sectional area (A), and modulus of elasticity (E). The members are inclined at 45° as shown in the figure. The truss has hinge supports at P and R . The translational degrees-of-freedom (u and v) are shown at joint Q .



(Figure not to scale)

After application of the boundary conditions, the stiffness matrix of the truss becomes: (GATE CE 2026)

a) $\frac{AE}{L} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$

b) $\frac{AE}{L} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0.5 \\ 0.5 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$

c) $\frac{AE}{L} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$

d) $\frac{AE}{L} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$

Solution: The unit direction vectors of the members are

$$\mathbf{m}_{PQ} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{m}_{QR} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.12.1)$$

From (1.1.13.1),

$$\mathbf{k}_{PQ} = \frac{AE}{L} \mathbf{m}_{PQ} \mathbf{m}_{PQ}^T = \frac{AE}{L} \begin{pmatrix} 0.5 & 0.5 \\ 0.5 & 0.5 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.12.2)$$

$$\mathbf{k}_{QR} = \frac{AE}{L} \mathbf{m}_{QR} \mathbf{m}_{QR}^T = \frac{AE}{L} \begin{pmatrix} 0.5 & -0.5 \\ -0.5 & 0.5 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.12.3)$$

Assembling the global system (1.1.13.2) and deleting the restrained degrees of freedom at P and R , only the (u, v) block at Q receives contributions from both members:

$$\mathbf{K} = \mathbf{k}_{PQ} + \mathbf{k}_{QR} = \frac{AE}{L} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.12.4)$$

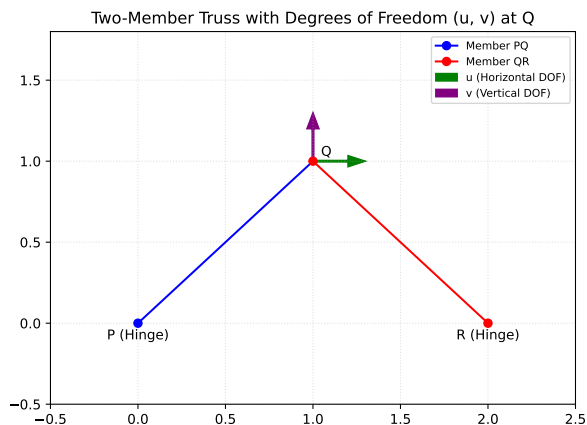


Fig. 1.2.12.1. Two-member truss with degrees of freedom u, v at Q

codes/ce1q38/q38.py

codes/ce1q38/q38plot.py

1.2.13 The plane frame has a hinge and a roller support, and is loaded as shown in the figure. Both the columns have same height.

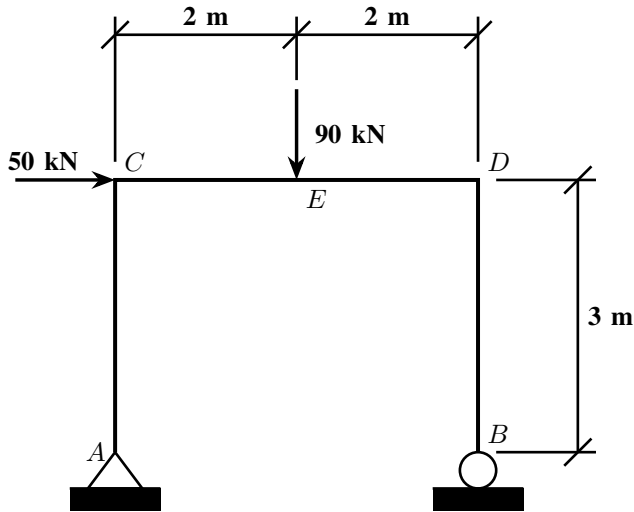
What is the absolute value of the maximum bending moment (in kN-m) in the frame?
(GATE CE 2026)

a) 165

b) 150

c) 240

d) 195



(Figure not to scale)

Solution: From the figure, the frame has a hinge at A , a roller at B , columns of height 3 m and a beam CD of span 4 m. A horizontal load of 50 kN acts at C and a vertical load of 90 kN acts at the mid-point E of CD :

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{C} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{E} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{D} = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{B} = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.13.1)$$

$$\mathbf{F}_C = \begin{pmatrix} 50 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{F}_E = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -90 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.13.2)$$

The hinge gives two reaction components and the roller gives a vertical reaction only, so

$$\mathbf{R}_A = \begin{pmatrix} H_A \\ V_A \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{R}_B = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ V_B \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.13.3)$$

From (1.1.12.1), the force equilibrium is $\mathbf{R}_A + \mathbf{R}_B + \mathbf{F}_C + \mathbf{F}_E = \mathbf{0}$ and the moment equilibrium about A , using $\mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{F} = r_x F_y - r_y F_x$, requires

$$(\mathbf{C} - \mathbf{A}) \times \mathbf{F}_C = 0 \times 0 - 3 \times 50 = -150 \quad (1.2.13.4)$$

$$(\mathbf{E} - \mathbf{A}) \times \mathbf{F}_E = 2 \times (-90) - 3 \times 0 = -180 \quad (1.2.13.5)$$

$$(\mathbf{B} - \mathbf{A}) \times \mathbf{R}_B = 4 \times V_B - 0 \times 0 = 4V_B \quad (1.2.13.6)$$

to add up to zero. Let $\mathbf{x} = (H_A \quad V_A \quad V_B)^\top$. The three equilibrium conditions

give the residual vector

$$\mathbf{e}(\mathbf{x}) = \begin{pmatrix} H_A + 50 \\ V_A + V_B - 90 \\ 4V_B - 150 - 180 \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{S}\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{b}, \quad \mathbf{S} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 4 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} -50 \\ 90 \\ 330 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.13.7)$$

which is of the form (1.1.3.1) (the matrix is named $\mathbf{S}$ to avoid confusion with the point $\mathbf{A}$). The body is in equilibrium only if $\mathbf{e} = \mathbf{0}$, so we require its squared norm to be zero:

$$\|\mathbf{e}\|^2 = (H_A + 50)^2 + (V_A + V_B - 90)^2 + (4V_B - 330)^2 = 0 \quad (1.2.13.8)$$

From (1.1.3.5), a vector has zero norm if and only if it is the zero vector, so $\mathbf{e} = \mathbf{0}$, that is, each term vanishes:

$$H_A + 50 = 0, \quad 4V_B - 330 = 0, \quad V_A + V_B - 90 = 0 \quad (1.2.13.9)$$

These equations are $\mathbf{S}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$. Row reducing the augmented matrix,

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & -50 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 90 \\ 0 & 0 & 4 & 330 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_3 \rightarrow \frac{1}{4}R_3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & -50 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 90 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 82.5 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.13.10)$$

$$\xrightarrow{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - R_3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & -50 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 7.5 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 82.5 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.13.11)$$

From (1.1.3.2), $\text{rank}(\mathbf{S}) = \text{rank}(\mathbf{S} \mid \mathbf{b}) = 3 = n$, so $\|\mathbf{e}\|^2 = 0$ holds for exactly one $\mathbf{x}$:

$$H_A = -50, \quad V_A = 7.5, \quad V_B = 82.5 \quad (1.2.13.12)$$

that is, $\mathbf{R}_A = \begin{pmatrix} -50 \\ 7.5 \end{pmatrix}$ kN (the horizontal component acts towards the left) and

$$\mathbf{R}_B = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 82.5 \end{pmatrix} \text{ kN}.$$

The bending moment is found from (1.1.12.2). In the column AC , at a section $\mathbf{P} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ y \end{pmatrix}$ (forces below the section),

$$M(\mathbf{P}) = (\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{P}) \times \mathbf{R}_A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -y \end{pmatrix} \times \begin{pmatrix} -50 \\ 7.5 \end{pmatrix} = 0 \times 7.5 - (-y)(-50) = -50y \quad (1.2.13.13)$$

so $\|M(\mathbf{P})\| = 50y$ grows linearly from 0 at A to

$$\|M_C\| = 50 \times 3 = 150 \text{ kN m} \quad (1.2.13.14)$$

In the beam CD , at a section $\mathbf{P} = \begin{pmatrix} x \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}$ (forces to the right of the section),

$$M(\mathbf{P}) = (\mathbf{B} - \mathbf{P}) \times \mathbf{R}_B + (\mathbf{E} - \mathbf{P}) \times \mathbf{F}_E \quad (1.2.13.15)$$

$$= \begin{cases} 82.5(4-x) - 90(2-x) = 150 + 7.5x, & 0 \leq x \leq 2 \\ 82.5(4-x), & 2 \leq x \leq 4 \end{cases} \quad (1.2.13.16)$$

which is positive and increasing from 150 to 165 on $0 \leq x \leq 2$ and decreasing from 165 to 0 on $2 \leq x \leq 4$, so the maximum in the beam occurs under the load at E :

$$M_E = (\mathbf{B} - \mathbf{E}) \times \mathbf{R}_B = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -3 \end{pmatrix} \times \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 82.5 \end{pmatrix} = 2 \times 82.5 - (-3) \times 0 = 165 \text{ kN m} \quad (1.2.13.17)$$

so $\|M_E\| = 165 \text{ kN m}$. The beam value $\|M(\mathbf{P})\| = 150$ at $x = 0$ equals $\|M_C\|$ from the column, as it must since the joint C is in moment equilibrium (the signs differ only because the two sections are taken on different sides of the joint). In the column BD , the roller reaction is vertical and acts along the column, so $(\mathbf{B} - \mathbf{P}) \times \mathbf{R}_B = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -y \end{pmatrix} \times \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 82.5 \end{pmatrix} = 0$ and $M = 0$. Therefore

$$\max \|M\| = \max (\|M_C\|, \|M_E\|, 0) = \max (150, 165, 0) = 165 \text{ kN m} \quad (1.2.13.18)$$

As a check, substituting the reactions gives $\|\mathbf{e}\| = \left\| \begin{pmatrix} -50 + 50 \\ 7.5 + 82.5 - 90 \\ 4 \times 82.5 - 330 \end{pmatrix} \right\| = \|\mathbf{0}\| = 0$. Hence the maximum absolute bending moment is 165 kN m, which is option (a).

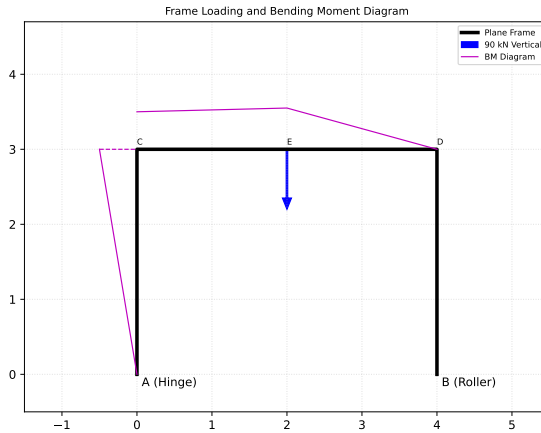


Fig. 1.2.13.1. Frame loading and bending moment diagram

codes/ce1q39/q39.py

codes/ce1q39/q39plot.py

1.2.14 Starting with the first approximation as $x = 0.5$, the second approximation for the root of the following function by the Newton-Raphson method is _____ (rounded off to two decimal places).

$$f(x) = e^{-x} - x \quad (1.2.14.1)$$

(GATE CE 2026)

Solution: The function and its derivative are

$$f(x) = e^{-x} - x \quad (1.2.14.2)$$

$$f'(x) = -e^{-x} - 1 \quad (1.2.14.3)$$

Substituting into (1.1.10.1):

$$x_{n+1} = x_n + \frac{e^{-x_n} - x_n}{e^{-x_n} + 1} \quad (1.2.14.4)$$

$$= \frac{1 + x_n}{1 + e^{x_n}} \quad (1.2.14.5)$$

With the first approximation $x_0 = 0.5$, the second approximation is

$$x_1 = \frac{1.5}{1 + e^{0.5}} = \frac{1.5}{2.64872} = 0.56631 \approx 0.57 \quad (1.2.14.6)$$

Subsequent iterations converge to $x_2 = x_3 = 0.567143$.

The following C code verifies the approximations:

codes/ce1q48/q48.c

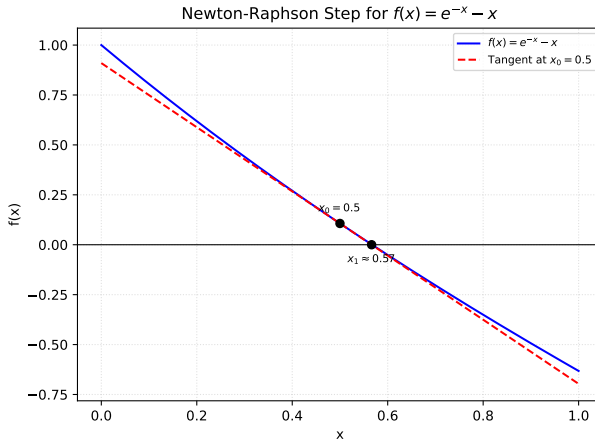


Fig. 1.2.14.1. One Newton-Raphson step for $f(x) = e^{-x} - x$ from $x_0 = 0.5$

codes/ce1q48/q48.py

codes/ce1q48/q48plot.py

1.2.15 Values of y for different values of x are tabulated below.

x	-2	1	2
y	28	4	16

If a second-degree interpolating polynomial $P_2(x)$ is used to represent y , the value of $P_2(0)$ is _____ (rounded off to the nearest integer). (GATE CE 2026)

Solution: Let $\mathbf{c} = (c_0 \ c_1 \ c_2)^\top$ and $\mathbf{y} = (28 \ 4 \ 16)^\top$. From (1.1.11.1),

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -2 & 4 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 & 4 \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{c} = \mathbf{y} \quad (1.2.15.1)$$

Reducing the augmented matrix:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -2 & 4 & 28 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 & 4 \\ 1 & 2 & 4 & 16 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow[R_3 \rightarrow R_3 - R_1]{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - R_1} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -2 & 4 & 28 \\ 0 & 3 & -3 & -24 \\ 0 & 4 & 0 & -12 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.15.2)$$

$$\Rightarrow c_1 = -3, \ c_2 = 5, \ c_0 = 2 \quad (1.2.15.3)$$

Thus,

$$\mathbf{c} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -3 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix} \Rightarrow P_2(x) = 5x^2 - 3x + 2 \quad (1.2.15.4)$$

and

$$P_2(0) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{c} = 2 \quad (1.2.15.5)$$

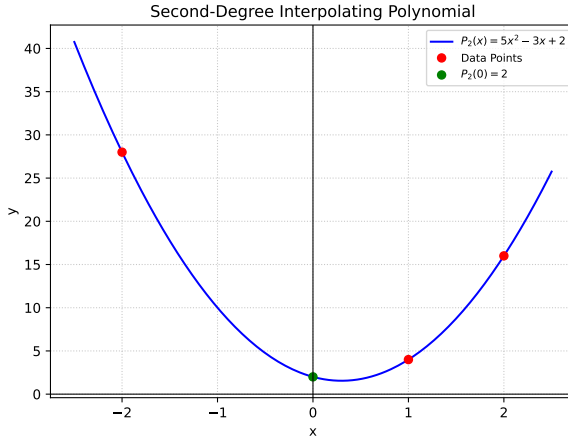
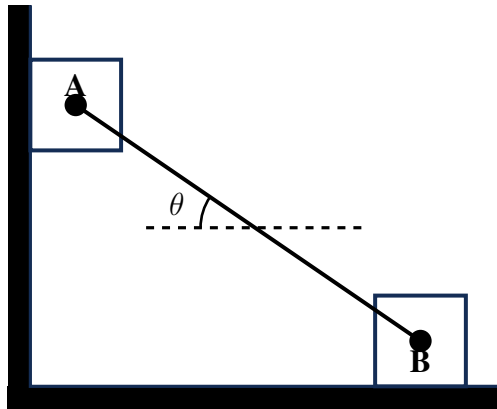


Fig. 1.2.15.1. Interpolating polynomial through the given points

codes/ce1q49/q49.py

codes/ce1q49/q49plot.py

- 1.2.16 Two identical blocks A and B are connected by a rigid rod. The blocks rest against vertical and horizontal planes, as shown in the figure. The coefficient of static friction at the vertical and horizontal planes is the same. If the sliding impends when $\theta = 45^\circ$, the value of the coefficient of static friction is _____ (rounded off to two decimal places). (GATE CE 2026)



Solution: Assume that the rod is weightless and is smoothly pinned to the blocks, and that both blocks are identical, so each has weight W . Let the rod make angle θ with the horizontal, with $c = \cos \theta$, $s = \sin \theta$. A weightless rod with smooth pins carries force only along its length, so it is a two-force member carrying compression C along

$$\mathbf{e} = \frac{\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{B}}{\|\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{B}\|} = \begin{pmatrix} -c \\ s \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.16.1)$$

When sliding impends, we assume that A moves down and B moves away from the wall, which is the only motion consistent with the rod length being fixed, so from the limiting friction $F = \mu N$ in (1.1.12.3) the friction forces are μN_A (upward on A) and μN_B (towards the wall on B). Treating each block as a particle, the force equilibrium $\sum_i \mathbf{F}_i = \mathbf{0}$ of (1.1.12.1) gives:

$$\text{Block } A : \begin{pmatrix} N_A \\ \mu N_A \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -W \end{pmatrix} + C \begin{pmatrix} -c \\ s \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{0} \quad (1.2.16.2)$$

$$\text{Block } B : \begin{pmatrix} -\mu N_B \\ N_B \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -W \end{pmatrix} - C \begin{pmatrix} -c \\ s \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{0} \quad (1.2.16.3)$$

This gives four equations in three unknowns $(N_A \ N_B \ C)^\top$ of the form (1.1.3.1), with $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 3}$:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & -c \\ \mu & 0 & s \\ 0 & -\mu & c \\ 0 & 1 & -s \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} N_A \\ N_B \\ C \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ W \\ 0 \\ W \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.16.4)$$

Reducing the augmented matrix:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & -c & 0 \\ \mu & 0 & s & W \\ 0 & -\mu & c & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -s & W \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow[R_3 \rightarrow R_3 + \mu R_4]{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - \mu R_1} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & -c & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & s + \mu c & W \\ 0 & 0 & c - \mu s & \mu W \\ 0 & 1 & -s & W \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.16.5)$$

$$\xrightarrow{R_2 \leftrightarrow R_4} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & -c & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -s & W \\ 0 & 0 & c - \mu s & \mu W \\ 0 & 0 & s + \mu c & W \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.16.6)$$

Applying $R_4 \rightarrow (c - \mu s)R_4 - (s + \mu c)R_3$:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & -c & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -s & W \\ 0 & 0 & c - \mu s & \mu W \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & W(c(1 - \mu^2) - 2\mu s) \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.2.16.7)$$

By (1.1.3.2), the system is consistent only if $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = \text{rank}(\mathbf{A} \mid \mathbf{b})$. The first three rows have non-zero pivots in the three columns (the pivot $c - \mu s$ is positive for the μ found below), so $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = 3$. The fourth row is zero in $\mathbf{A}$, so $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A} \mid \mathbf{b}) = 3$ only if its last entry is zero:

$$W(c(1 - \mu^2) - 2\mu s) = 0 \quad (1.2.16.8)$$

$$\implies \tan \theta = \frac{1 - \mu^2}{2\mu} \quad (1.2.16.9)$$

For $\theta = 45^\circ$:

$$\mu^2 + 2\mu - 1 = 0 \implies \mu = -1 + \sqrt{2} = 0.414 \quad (1.2.16.10)$$

taking the positive root.

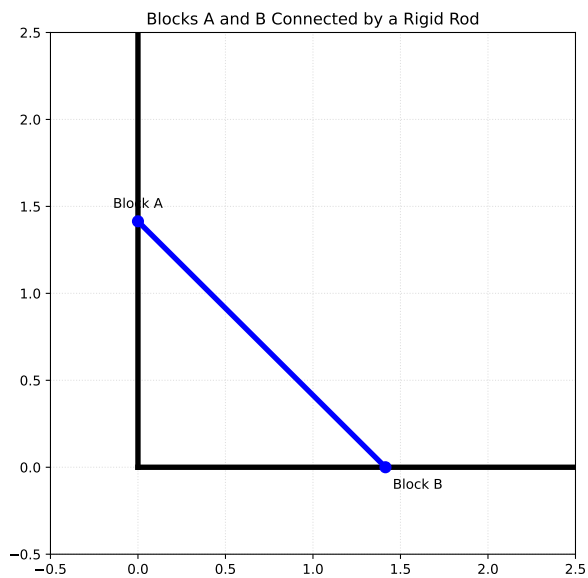


Fig. 1.2.16.1. Blocks A and B connected by a rigid rod at $\theta = 45^\circ$

codes/ce1q50/q50.py

codes/ce1q50/q50plot.py